Case Study on Designing Pages and Navigation for a Multi-Page Business Application

Name:	Irwin Inbadurai V.J	**Reg. No.:**	241201018
Course:		**Date:**	

Aim

To design a multi-page Zoho Creator application whose pages and menu let different users reach the right information with the fewest clicks.

Objectives

- Understand the role of pages, forms and reports in the user interface.
- Plan a navigation structure from user tasks.
- Design a home page with links and key figures.
- Evaluate the design against usability criteria.

Selected Application

Hostel Management System for a 300-student hostel (illustrative). The warden, the office clerk and the students all use one application, but each has different needs. A clear page structure is required so that nobody has to search through unrelated screens.

Concept: Pages and Navigation

In Zoho Creator a **page** is a freely designed screen that can combine text, images, buttons, charts and embedded reports; it is visually richer than a plain form or report. The application **menu** arranges forms, reports and pages into sections, and users see only what their role allows. Good navigation therefore starts with the question 'what does each person come here to do?'

Step 1: Identify User Tasks

User	Frequent tasks	Needs quickly
Warden	Approve leave, check occupancy, review complaints	Summary and pending items
Office clerk	Allot rooms, record fees, update records	Data entry forms and lists
Student	Request leave, raise a complaint, view room details	Simple 2 or 3 options

Step 2: Plan the Page Structure

Page / section	Type	Contents	Audience
Home	Page	Welcome banner, 4 summary tiles, shortcut buttons	All
Rooms	Section	Room Allotment form, Room Status report	Clerk, Warden
Students	Section	Student Admission form, Student Directory report	Clerk
Requests	Section	Leave Request form, Complaint form, My Requests report	Student, Warden
Fees	Section	Fee Payment form, Pending Fees report	Clerk
Insights	Page	Occupancy chart, complaints by type	Warden

Step 3: Design the Home Page

The home page is built on a page canvas using layout elements. It follows a simple top-to-bottom order so that a user's eye meets the most important information first.

Zone	Element	Purpose
Top	Title bar with hostel name	Orientation
Upper	Four tiles: Total students, Rooms vacant, Leave pending, Complaints open	Instant status
Middle	Buttons: New Allotment, New Leave Request, New Complaint	One-click actions
Lower	Embedded report: Latest 10 complaints	Recent activity

Step 4: Configure Menu and Role-Based Access

- Arrange sections in the order of daily use and keep section names short and in plain words.
- Use **permissions** so students never see Fees or Students sections.
- Set the Home page as the default landing page for every role.
- Add a 'Back to Home' button on custom pages to avoid dead ends.

Step 5: Usability Review

Criterion	Check	Result target
Clicks to main task	Raise a complaint from Home	2 clicks or fewer
Consistency	Same names for same things on all pages	Yes
Clutter	Items per menu section	Not more than 5
Mobile view	Open page on a phone	Tiles stack, buttons readable
Role fit	Log in as each role	Only relevant items visible

Results

- Grouping items by user task produced a shorter and clearer menu than grouping by database table.
- A summary home page reduced the need to open reports for routine checks.
- Role-based visibility made the application look simple for students while remaining complete for staff.

Conclusion

Navigation is part of the application's quality, not decoration. By planning pages from user tasks, limiting menu items and controlling visibility by role, even a large application feels simple. Zoho Creator's page builder and menu settings provide the tools; the design discipline comes from understanding the users.

Sources consulted: Zoho Creator Help documentation (forms, reports, pages, workflows, Deluge); Zoho Corporation press release on Creator AI features (April 2025) and its coverage in IT Brief; Zoho Creator Decode article on Zia-assisted Deluge (March 2026). The business scenario in this report is illustrative, and figures in it are assumed values used to demonstrate the method, not measured results.